Capstone Project Proposal Rubric
Research Methods and Professional Practice

Deliverables

1. A **Presentation** that clearly states a proposed project geared towards a specific audience with a problem or experience you are designing around. The presentation pitch should also clearly state the project's Domains of Interest (subject matter and tools or platforms used). Presentations will take place at the end of the semester.

2. A completed **Proposal Document** that is realistic and challenging within the Capstone timeframe. The proposal must include a detailed production timeline, bill of materials / list of functional specs, and visual renderings of the work.

When reviewing and approving Capstone project proposals, ATLAS faculty will consider how well the project demonstrates: Research, Feasibility, Preparedness and Relevance to CTD.

Rubric for a Successful Capstone Project Proposal & Pitch

- **Improves the world** in some way or **adds value to an experience** through the implementation of engineering, art and/or design.

- Demonstrates **technical mastery** specific to Engineering / CTD as part of the *process*, *execution* and/or *presentation* of the work.

- The project has been designed for a clearly defined **experience and/or problem** focused on a specific **audience**.

- The student has completed three stages of **idea validation**:
    - **Precedent Research**. The student has engaged in thorough research and exploration of what has already been done in the field - successfully and unsuccessfully - and has clearly articulated this in the final proposal document, as well as concisely explained it in the final pitch presentation.
    - **User Interviews / Observations**. The student has connected with users/audience, mentors, and experts in the field to explore their identified problem/experience and prove possible solutions. The findings from this stage validate the following questions: Does the problem / experience actually exist? Is my proposed solution appropriate and effective?
    - **Feasibility Tests**. The student has engaged in a series of small experiments to test the content and technical feasibility of their proposed project. The findings from this stage validate: Is the proposed project technically feasible? Is the scope of the project appropriate for Capstone?

- The proposed project is **feasible** while also challenging the student(s)' current technical skills.

- The **proposal document** is detailed and complete. It includes a comprehensive timeline as well as a bill of materials / list of functional specs.